October 2026
50th Year of Growth
1976 - 2026

Contact Email: secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com
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The DGC committee meeting was held on 23rd September 2026 at 7.30 pm.
The next DGC meeting will be held on **Wednesday, 11 November 2026**
7.30 pm at the RSL Hall , cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street. Doors open at 7.15pm

Please note that there is no meeting on 14th October 2026

Committee Members 2026

President
Avril Clark
0402 478 302
president@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Vice-President & Speaker Bookings:
Vacant

Treasurer:
Dr Margaret Salter

Secretary:
Virgina Roberts & Connie Lee
secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Fund Raising Co-Ordinator:
Anita Luzza

Newsletter:
Rohini Padey
newseditor@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Reinhard

Esther Sim

Ray Brett

President's message.

On Saturday 3rd October 2026, Doncaster Garden Club members gathered to celebrate the Club's 50th birthday. Six of our Life members joined us for the party and we had several guests : Gabriel Ng. Committee members from Ivanhoe Garden Club and Preston Garden Club, our Guest Speaker Jacquie Chirgwin and Derek and Jane Baskerville, President and Secretary respectively of the RSL Branch, Doncaster, as well as several family members that came along to support the Life members.

The tables were decorated for a Gardener's afternoon tea – white tablecloths, garden themed runners and fresh flowers on each table. All food was catered for and each table had boxes of delicious afternoon tea that provided something for everyone as well as those who had specific food requirements. The birthday cake was a delicious vanilla cake, filled with berry compote,and buttercream icing and fresh berries on top.

We were reminded how talented our Club members have been with 2 gold John Pascoe Fawkner medals and several S.S. McKay Memorial medals over the fifty years. We noted the awards to Alana Camilleri and Edward Page as well, not forgetting Anita Luzza being a nominee for the Manningham awards.

It was particularly fitting that Past President Pauline Webb was awarded the Alice Williams Clark medallion by Garden Clubs of Australia. Maureen Lucas, Director of Awards, Garden Clubs of Australia (our affiliate body) handed the medal to Pauline for her services to the Club.

Jacquie Chirgwin spoke to us about her journey in Garden design, which is particularly focussed on wellness and healing for recovering breast cancer patients. She shared some magnificent photos of two of her own recent properties and the design process involved. The Garden Club is delighted to donate $300 to Jacquie's charity "Breast Cancer Trials"

Lastly, but by no means least, we had the fabulous raffle put together by Anita. There were some really fantastic prizes here and we are very grateful to all the donors for their generous gifts.

The Committee hopes that everyone had an enjoyable time and thanks to you all for making it a memorable event.

Doncaster Garden Club Subscriptions are due for renewal by the 31st October 2026

Please bring your returnable bottles and cans each month so we can collect the 10c deposit to add to the DGC financial reserve. (No squashed cans please)



The beautiful Birthday cake



A birds eyes view of the party



Derek and Jane Baskerville, President and Secretary respectively of the RSL Branch, Doncaster



Jacquie Chrigwin our speaker



Avril, Pauline and Maureen with the Award Alice Williams Clark medallion by Garden Clubs of Australia



Certificate of Appreciation for DGC from Garden Clubs of Australia






Doncaster RSL
Sub - Branch
WE LOOK FOR
OUR
COMMUNITY
SUPPORT!











September meeting - Clare Harvey on growing different varities of Corn

Clare from Mannigham Council gave us a lot of information about Corn - the history of it and how to grow it. She ahd a beautiful presentation that told us about how was grown in the ancient cultures and how we have used it over the centuries for many things. In ancient cultures they revered the corn and had a corn goddes that mayans would pray to.

She talked about the different varieties of corn and how they can consumed, some corn has to be dried and then made into flour and others can be popped and eaten as popcorn.

She was very generous and shared with us a bottle of poprcon seeds called "Amish Buttercream"so we that club members could try to grow it. Please get in touch with the secreatries if you would like to get some seeds we may have spare ones.

She talked about the way in which corn can be grown and the soil and sun that it requires. The 3 sisters is a popular way of growing corn with beans and pumpkin. The 3 plants grow well to together and support each other nutritionally and phyisically.



https://www.manningham.vic.gov.au/news/your-fruit-tree-net-legal-if-not-swap-it-free



Upcoming Calendar Events:

Upcoming Committee Meeting:	**28 October**	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Upcoming Meeting:	**11 November**	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

Our speaker at the November meeting will be Helen Lovel from Nutrog

Following Committee Meeting:	**02 December**	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Following Meeting	**09 December**	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

Open Garden at Avril Clark's house

Saturday14th November, 2.30 - 4pm

RSVP with name and phone no (in case we get rained out!) by Wednesday 11th November

Avril@spiritofprogress.net

Hello Gardeners All

What a blessing to have a lovely warm day today, Monday. There was very little rain the previous 3 days. I measured a bare 5mm totalling just over 27mm for the month. This is about or under half of the September average so the soil moisture is vanishing fast. Do a finger test on moisture loving plants: push a finger deep into the soil. If there is moisture below the 50mm mark the plant is ok. If dry, the plant or bed needs watering.

Trevor and I spent a couple of hours yesterday preparing 2 large beds, one for tomatoes, the other for sweet corn, climbing beans and maybe a pumpkin. I always want to plant more vegetables than I have room for! We had home made compost, Neutrog's Choc a Block where I ran out, and Neutrog's Gigantic as summer fruiting veggies are very hungry. All was covered with 50mm of used sugarcane mulch which had overwintered on the bed or fresh pea straw, to protect the soil until I plant and to prevent more weeds.

The tomatoes are desperate to be planted - hungry and flowering in 50mm pots so I hope they take off well. The current crops are I picked all the silverbeet and perpetual spinach ie minature silverbeet in appearance, as they were commencing to seed and am preparing it to keep long term for soups, casseroles etc. It is called Gundruk: remove stalks and use separately; wilt the leaves a day, slice into ribbons; rub with non iodised salt; place in a clean dark vessel to ferment 3-5days depending on temperature and aroma of leaf and salt; drain juices and spread on drying racks and dry in sun or lowest setting of the oven. When crunchy and can be broken up easily, pack into an airtight jar and store in the dark pantry. The Stalks can be stir fried with garlic, or simmered with a can of beans with garlic or anchovies. All are delicious. There is always steamed garlic with cheese sauce too.

The skirrit and yacon are in the ground, barely shooting. I am favouring more perrenial crops as they take less work. The choko did not die right back in winter as the 2-3 barely there frosts didn't do the normal damage. It is already shooting and growing well and flowers in my yard in autumn. The garlic is growing well and a careful finger can feel the bulbs swelling well. The 2 beds of red shallot are looking good. The small bed had an insect infestation (maybe a fine dark aphis) but it cleared with 2 sprays of feverfew tea and are growing well again. The Seasol drink likely helped too.

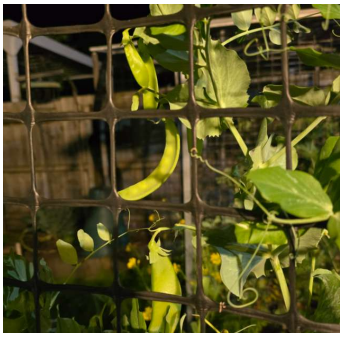
The cauliflowers appear to be curling tight as they start the curd process. The Rhubarb is producing adequately and is delicious cooked with apple or honey or berries. When the tomatoes are planted it will be time to put in cucmber and eggplant seeds for planting in November. Last year's trial of the Peruvian stuffing cucumber which cropped late summer and autumn was successful and is worth doing again. They are not like a normal cucumber, not having a juicy middle but pickled and stir fried and souped well. It is a more substantial veg and is picked at 50-100mm long. If longer they are only good for stuffing. The same difference as in small to large zucchini. It also climbs well and needs a trellis.

I'm happy to be asked questions re growing veggies at the meetings or on the phone. Also note that the internet is full of good advice. The LFC Newsletter and BAAG both have local growing info. With the possible to likely increases in fuel and cost of food this year, growing more at home is very cost efficient. I save seeds so have many I can share. Just ask

Until Next time, Happy Gardening Pauline







DGC Life Members

Gerda van der Peet
Doug Brewer
Gayle McCann
Ted Page

Joanne Driver
Elsie Carter
Bev Turner
Franziska Kung









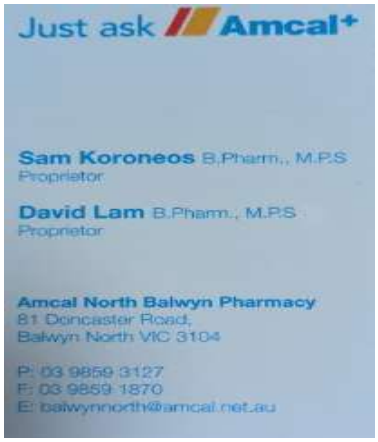


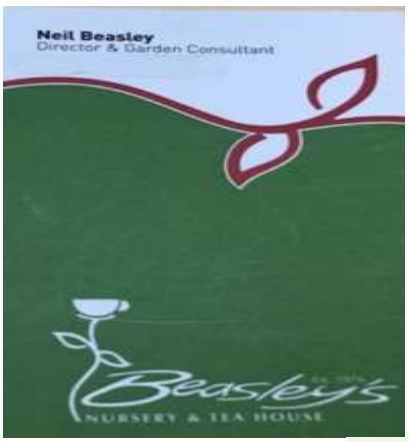
The Ryset Catalogue can https://ryset.com

The Club receives wholesale prices which means discounts of up to 60-70%















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